

Samuel Morgan Martin

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🏛 U of T Profile

Education

PhD	University of Toronto , Political Science • Fields: Comparative Politics, International Relations	Toronto, ON 2022 – present
MA	University of Toronto , Political Science	Toronto, ON 2021 – 2022
BA	University of Victoria , Political Science • Honours with Distinction	Victoria, BC 2015 – 2020

Fellowships and Awards

Doctoral Fellowship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada • \$80,000 CAD	2024 – 2026
APSA Political Networks Section Travel Grant • \$500 USD	Aug 2026

Recent Conference and Workshop Presentations

Power Play: Elite Networks and Authoritarian Leadership Challenges APSA Annual Meeting, Boston, MA	Sept 2026
Power Play: How Networks Structure Credible Commitment in Authoritarian Leadership Challenges Annual Political Networks Conference, Manchester, UK	Aug 2026
Decoding Networks: Open-Weights LLMs for Network Data Extraction Blalock Lecture Series, ICPSR Summer Program, Ann Arbor, MI	July 2026
Power Play: How Networks Structure Credible Commitment in Authoritarian Leadership Challenges MPSA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	Apr 2026
The Betweenniks: Coups, Coup Proofing, and Autocratic Elite Networks Annual Political Networks Conference, Boston, MA	Aug 2025
The Betweenniks: Coups, Coup Proofing, and Autocratic Elite Networks Prairie Political Science Association Conference, Banff, AB	Aug 2025

Poster Presentations

Decoding Networks: Open-Weights LLMs for Network Data Extraction PolMeth Summer Meeting, East Lansing, MI	July 2026
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Research Assistantships

Elite Networks and Autocratic Stability: Application to Putin's Russia Research assistant to Professor Olga Chyzh. • Developed automated network data collection procedures using large language models.	Jan 2025 – present
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Who Voted for the Guns of August? Research assistant to Professor Brendan McElroy. • Literature review, data collection, and archival work in Russian.	Jan 2024
The Cultural Politics of Infrastructure Research assistant to Professor Theresa Enright on her SSHRC-funded project. • Conducted literature review, collected data, and conducted interviews.	Jan 2022
Comparative Politics in Canada Research assistant to Professors Michelle Bonner and Rita Tremblay. • Collected data on comparative politics researchers in Canada.	Jan 2019

Teaching (Methods)

Network Analysis II, ICPSR Summer Program Teaching assistant for Professors Olga Chyzh and Shahryar Minhas.	2024 – 2026
POL304: Quantitative Study of War Teaching assistant for Professor Mark Nieman.	Winter 2025
POL304: Using Data to Understand Politics and Society Teaching assistant for Professor Olga Chyzh.	Winter 2024

Teaching (Substantive)

POL380: Terrorism and Insurgency Teaching assistant for Professor Olga Chyzh.	Winter 2026
POL212: Understanding War Teaching assistant for Professor Dani K. Nedal.	Fall 2025
POL354: Russian Politics Teaching assistant for Professor Brendan McElroy.	Fall 2024, 2025
POLA01: Revolutions Teaching assistant for Professor Lucan Way.	Fall 2024
POL107: What Went Wrong? A Post Mortem of Political Disasters, Catastrophic Policy Failures, and Epic Marches of Folly Teaching assistant for Professor Lilach Gilady.	Fall 2023
POL354: Russian Politics Teaching assistant for Professor Ed Schatz.	Fall 2023
POL305: The International Politics of Authoritarianisms Teaching assistant for Semuhi Sinanoglu.	Fall 2023
POL101: The Real World of Politics Teaching assistant for Professor Courtney Jung.	Fall 2023

Service and Research Program Organization

Comparative Autocracy Student Research Cluster

University of Toronto

Co-Chair, Department of Political Science.

2022 – 2023

- Book talk: *Revolution and Dictatorship* by Dr. Lucan Way (November 2022).
- Book talk: *Outsourcing Repression* by Dr. Lynette Ong (December 2022).
- Thesis workshop: "State-Business Relations under Assad 1991-2011" by Gamal Mansour (January 2023).
- Paper workshop: "Moscow Must Pay: the economy of central control in Putin's Russia" by Samuel Morgan Martin (November 2023).

Professional Development

Bellingcat RUnet Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) Workshop

Aug 2023

Skills

Methods: Network analysis, Natural Language Processing, Spatial Statistics, Panel Data

Software: R, Python, vLLM

Languages

English: Native speaker

Russian: Intermediate